Sunil Chaudhari

Lead Software Release Manager | Release & Delivery Governance | Certified Scrum Master (CSM®, CSPO)

sunilibn@gmail.com | +91-9657724967 | Pune, India | linkedin.com/in/snapsunil

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Release and delivery leader with 15+ years in software delivery and 6+ years managing production releases, across HealthTech (Bajaj Finserv group), AdTech and enterprise SaaS. Owns the release calendar for 10+ interconnected microservices delivered by 5+ product squads, coordinating release scheduling, sequencing and cross-team dependencies through to production. Runs release readiness reviews and Go/No-Go decisions, achieving a 99.9% deployment success rate with zero-downtime releases. Enforces change governance through Azure DevOps approval gates, restricted production access and structured release communication. Drives release KPIs, cutting post-release incidents by 30% and improving delivery predictability by 25%. Gives leadership, up to CTO level, clear visibility into release health, risks and escalations.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Release Planning & Scheduling:** Release calendar ownership, biweekly release cycles, release sequencing, deployment windows
- **Release Readiness & Governance:** Readiness reviews, Go/No-Go decisions, entry/exit checks, change management, approval gates
- **Dependency Management:** Cross-team, infrastructure and partner/vendor dependencies; escalation and conflict resolution
- **Risk & Issue Management:** Early risk identification, mitigation and rollback planning, production incident triage, blocker resolution
- **Release Metrics:** Deployment success rate, post-release incidents, release predictability, on-time delivery, SLA performance
- **Stakeholder Management:** Engineering, product, QA, infrastructure, support and external partners; executive status reporting
- **DevOps & CI/CD:** Azure DevOps YAML and Classic Release pipelines, environment-based approval gates, ArgoCD, Power Automate
- **Agile Delivery:** Scrum, Kanban, SAFe practices, sprint and release planning
- **Tools:** Jira, Confluence, Azure DevOps, ELK Stack, Power Automate, AWS, SQL

WORK EXPERIENCE

Quality & Release Manager – Technology | Bajaj Finserv Health, Pune — Dec 2021 – Present

- Own the release calendar for 10+ interconnected microservices across 5+ product squads, planning biweekly release cycles, deployment windows and release sequencing.
- Run release readiness reviews and Go/No-Go decisions with Product and Delivery Managers, checking functional, regression and operational readiness before every production push.
- Deliver releases through Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines (YAML and Classic Release, environment-based approval gates, ArgoCD stages), achieving a 99.9% deployment success rate with zero-downtime production releases.
- Identify, track and resolve cross-team dependencies and release blockers across engineering, QA, product and infrastructure teams; escalate risks early and plan mitigation and rollback.
- Reduced post-release incident rate by 30% by introducing structured release notes, stakeholder communication templates and post-release monitoring protocols.
- Partnered with Product Managers to prioritize high-value backlog items, improving delivery predictability and velocity by 25%.
- Strengthened change governance as Azure DevOps Project Administrator by restricting production pipeline runs to an authorized group and tightening admin access.
- Coordinate external partners on API integrations and release-impacting issues; delivered a Power Automate solution linking Azure DevOps bugs to partner email notifications and posting partner replies back to DevOps.
- Lead the Production Support Engineering (PSE) team: production incident triage, SLA governance and ELK-based monitoring; assign and review work, coach and run performance reviews.
- Provide leadership visibility into release health, risks and escalations through regular status reports, including CTO-level updates.

RunOps Manager / Scrum Master | Zimetrics, Pune — May 2020 – Dec 2021

- Managed the end-to-end product delivery lifecycle for a SaaS platform, from development to production, coordinating design, engineering and QA stakeholders.

- Owned daily CI/CD pipeline operations and the weekly release cycle: prioritizing and scheduling production deployments and running release regression.
- Facilitated all Scrum ceremonies and delivered weekly and daily status reports (WSR/DSR) to leadership.
- Surfaced risks early and led mitigation planning, reducing deployment-related incidents.
- Maintained test suites and gave actionable QA feedback to Product Managers to speed up feature delivery.

QA Lead | Market Logic Software, Pune Aug 2018 – Apr 2020

- Led the Pune QA team, owning test strategy, resource planning, task allocation and execution across multiple product releases.
- Reported project status, resourcing needs and risks weekly to the QA Director; adjusted resource allocation with the QA Manager to keep delivery on schedule and to quality standards.
- Ran weekly release regression cycles and prioritized production deployments through an active CI/CD pipeline.

Sr. QA Engineer | AppDirect India Pvt Ltd, Pune Oct 2016 – Aug 2018

- Owned QA for an entire product module: test planning, test case design and end-to-end execution.
- Worked with the Product team on new features and acceptance criteria; coordinated production deployments for a stable CI/CD pipeline.

Sr. Software QA Engineer | PubMatic India Pvt Ltd, Pune Feb 2010 – Jan 2016

- Designed and executed test plans across functional, regression, integration and UAT testing.
- Set up and owned the UAT environment and sign-off process with business stakeholders before production releases.
- Wrote complex SQL queries to validate data integrity in advertising data pipelines.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Scrum Master (CSM®) – Scrum Alliance
- Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO) – Scrum Alliance

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Computer Science | Fergusson College, Pune | 2001 – 2005

INTERESTS

Fashion & Portrait Photography | Biking